

Chapter One: The Tidal Garden

We begin beside a garden where the tide moves through narrow channels. Each channel carries the same water, but each takes a different route among the stones.

Watching the water

The wide entrance fills slowly after dawn. Pale reflections gather along the bank while small insects settle on the reeds.

The first narrow channel

A thin stream bends around the first stone. Its quiet motion is one detail within the larger view of the water.

The eastern narrow channel

The eastern stream glints beneath the reeds. A bird waits on a smooth stone, then steps into the shallows as the water slips past its feet.

Reading the stones

The stones hold the warmth of the morning sun. Some are smooth and pale; others carry dark seams that disappear beneath the clear water.

Chapter Two: Walking Inland

The path leaves the shore and turns toward higher ground. We carry the observations from the garden into a different setting.

Higher ground

The open slope offers a broad view of the route. Beyond a stand of young trees, the distant shore fades into the morning haze.

The sheltered path

One path follows a low wall through a stand of trees. Fallen leaves soften the ground, and the air grows cooler where the branches meet overhead.